

DAY 1 · Thursday 20 August 2026 · Budapest

Arrival evening, Hungary's national day. Cross Liberty Bridge once, then walk north up the car-free Buda quay all evening.

4.0 km · ~50 min on foot · one river crossing · no backtracking · free



THE EVENING, IN ORDER

- 0 15:45 HOTEL — Sophia Palace, Fővám tér**
Vámház körút 2. Park at the Kelenföld P+R, buy the three 72-hour travelcards at the station machine, M4 straight in (12 min). Rest 16:15–17:30. Leave at 17:30.
- 1 17:30 Liberty Bridge — cross to Buda**
At the far end turn RIGHT, downstream, onto the lower quay. Do not walk north on the Pest side.
300 m
4 min
- 2 17:40 Buda lower quay — closed to cars**
Lower embankment shut to traffic 15–22 Aug: a riverside promenade for your dates. Hill above, Pest skyline opposite.
1.30 km
16 min
- 3 17:55 Döbrentei tér**
Buda foot of Elisabeth Bridge. Döbrentei utca is itself one of the food-street streets.
315 m
4 min
- 4 18:15 DINNER — Street of Hungarian Flavours**
Magyar Ízek Utcája, 09:00–24:00 on 20–22 Aug, across Várkert Bazár and the Várkert rakpart. First tasting of the Country's Bread and the Cake of Hungary. Beer capped under 1,000 HUF. No reservation.
1.9 km
24 min
- 5 19:00 Clark Ádám tér — under the Chain Bridge**
Leave dinner by 18:50, keep going north on the same car-free quay.
620 m
8 min
- 6 19:15 BEM RAKPART — spot for the 21:00 show**
Car-free quay square on Parliament; organisers say the Buda side is best. Sunset 19:50. 21:00: ~30 min projection + drones, 10 min of fireworks inside it. Light painting 22:30–01:00.
1.40 km
17 min

OPTIONS, AND ONE CLASH

- A** Batthyány tér (M2) — same view, has a metro
- B** Free disco, Kossuth tér, 21:30–01:30
- x** Holy Right Procession 19:00 — the clash

Map apps won't know this

The Buda lower embankment is closed to cars 15–22 Aug, but it's temporary so Google routes you along the road above it. Stay down by the water — that promenade is the point.

You can't also do the procession

The Holy Right leaves St Stephen's Basilica at 19:00, 2.6 km away on the Pest side. Pick one: a good spot for the show, or the procession and a worse view from Széchenyi István tér.